



HEALTH SERVICES SECTOR DEVELOPMENT PROJECT

September | 2021 Edition

NEWSLETTER

“HEALTH IS EVERYBODY’S BUSINESS!”

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MANAGERS MESSAGE



The Health Services Sector Development Project (HSSDP) aims to support the National Department of Health and Provincial Health Authorities to provide affordable, accessible, equitable and high quality services for all citizens with its projects deliverables.

This edition highlights activities undertaken by HSSDP over the past year.

Year 2020 and the first half of this year was a challenging time for everyone in the National and Provincial Offices due to COVID-19 lockdowns. Most of our international staff were not able to travel due to quarantine restrictions that affected the Project's activities both at the National and Provincial levels.

The lockdown affected the roll-out of Project's activities such as organisational development, health information systems and support for improvement of the national pharmaceutical and medical supplies procurement, warehousing & distribution systems and the planned suite of human resource development trainings.

Despite the situation, HSSDP has completed the Project's safeguards and confirmations of land ownership at several greenfield sites with Provinces, prior to tenders and construction of the proposed health facilities. Currently, Pomio District Hospital, Ambunti Health Centre and Kapiago Health Centre, Bitokara CHP, Umba CHP and Gaulim Health Centre are all under construction. The Civil Works program remains largely on track.

On behalf of the Project, I would like to acknowledge and thank both Ms Vicki Assenheim and Mr Kelwyn Browne for their contributions to the project and the support given to the people of PNG over the past years. Vicki left the Project in May to take up a position in Nauru and Kel is currently working with PATH.

Project updates are highlighted for your perusal in this newsletter.

Enjoy reading!

Rob Akers
Project Manager



HSSDP CIVIL WORKS



Above left: 3D view showing an example of a similar design of Mabudawan Health Centre in Western Province. Center: An example of Urban Clinic in 3D view. Right: A 3D view of a Community Health Post. © HSSDP | 2021

The Health Services Sector Development Project (HSSDP) has now confirmed its list of Project health facilities for development including District Hospitals, Health Centres and Community Health Posts.

The Project is aimed to strengthen health services through policy reforms and direct investments in health systems to achieve result orientated outcomes within the rural sectors of Papua New Guinea (PNG) through the improvement of basic health services while saving lives of many suffering communities within the remote locations in PNG. It is designed to be implemented over a seven-year period with the outcomes of affordable, accessible, equitable, and high quality health services deliverable for all citizens in selected rural communities of PNG. The program is also aligned with NDOH's National Health Plans.

- ◆ Bogia District Hospital, Madang Province
- ◆ Pomio District Hospital, East New Britain Province
- ◆ Kopiago Health Centre, Hela Province
- ◆ Cape Gloucester Health Centre, West New Britain Province
- ◆ Ambunti Health Centre, East Sepik Province
- ◆ Agevairua Health Centre, Central Province
- ◆ Ihu Health Centre, Gulf Province
- ◆ Karap Health Centre, Jiwaka Province
- ◆ Kunua Health Centre, AROB
- ◆ Wirui Urban Clinic, East Sepik Province
- ◆ Gaulim Community Health Post, East New Britain Province
- ◆ Bitokara Community Health Post, West New Britain Province
- ◆ Warasikau Community Health Post, West Sepik Province
- ◆ Talyokos Community Health Post, Enga Province
- ◆ Maramuni Community Health Post, Enga Province
- ◆ Kapou Community Health Post, Manus Province
- ◆ Kinjibi Community Health Post, Western Highlands Province
- ◆ Umba Community Health Post, Morobe Province

The development of modern health facilities will improve client focus which will be a challenge to most of our health staff in the country. This is an ideal opportunity for our health staff to change the work practices at the new health facilities to improve our health indicators and the hygiene of the health facilities both inside and outside. These initiatives will also address improved access to medical supplies and improved staff housing. Different levels of health facilities will require different numbers of staff houses. Staff at each new health facility will have access to specific clinical upskilling courses in maternal and child health and upskilling in sexual and reproductive health practice.

The Government is interested in building new health facilities on State land or in a partnership arrangements with Church Health Services to improve health services where that is in-line with ADB Social and Environment Safeguards. There will be no development on customary land or on land that is subject to land disputes.



Picture above: Aerial view of the current Ambunti Health Centre.



AMBUNTI HEALTH CENTRE - EAST SEPIK



Above picture: Ambunti Health Centre under construction, ESP.
© HSSDP | 2021

Ambunti Health Centre is going through a transformation that most people at the Station enjoy to watch. Old buildings that once occupied the premises of Ambunti Health Centre have been pulled down.

The design of the new Health facility is adapted from Mabudawan Health Centre in Western Province which was commissioned and opened in 2020 under the management of Rural Primary Health Services Delivery Project.

The construction is within the existing health centre site and includes the main building with 18 acute beds, a waiting house for expectant mothers, amenities for guardians, generator and incinerator sheds, 16 staff houses and other support buildings.

All buildings were designed and are constructed in accordance with the National Health Service Standards and the Building Code of PNG that includes engineering, environment safety, security and spatial efficiency aspects of the health facilities.

The design facilitates person centred care that includes; amenities for prevention of infection & control, fire control, accident prevention and disabled access through ramped entrances and adapted amenities such as bathrooms. Low-carbon and energy efficient measures, including solar power generation and solar hot water supplies are incorporated.



Old buildings of Ambunti Health Centre that has been pulled down for an upgrade. © HSSDP | 2021

It is almost 50 years since Ambunti Health Centre has been given a real makeover to meet the Level three standard of the National Department of Health Standard.

This project will restore access to basic health services that has been missing in the rural and remote areas of the District and its surrounding communities that needed it most.



Above picture: Beginning of construction at Ambunti Health Centre.
Picture below: Front view of Ambunti HC under construction.
©HSSDP | 2021.



Picture below: Community consultation, Ambunti Station, ESP.
© HSSDP | 2019



From consultations, negotiations, partnerships and land confirmations over the years, Ambunti has finally come to enjoy watching the physical structures being put together.

Women living in the vicinity of Ambunti Station have expressed their excitement to watch how change has taken place day by day. The women said that they have the desire to see the finished product and wonder how it would look like. Most importantly, the women are eager to see doctors, HEOs and nurses providing services in their new Health Facility once it is finished.

An elderly woman said, “the time to travel Wewak to go to Boram Hospital shall come to pass, we want more qualified health workers to ease the burdens faced by lots of mothers of our surrounding communities.”



POMIO DISTRICT HOSPITAL AT PALMALMAL

Palmalmal Health Centre is being upgraded to a level 4 District Hospital which will be known as the Pomio District Hospital.

The new District Hospital is situated at Palmalmal Town close to the old Palmalmal Health Centre on the opposite side of the road in Pomio District, East New Britain Province. It is also not far from the main District Administration office. Palmalmal is 16 hours away on a ship to Rabaul and about 50 to 60 minutes by air on a small plane from Rabaul to Jacquinot Bay.

HSSDP is currently managing civil works of the new Pomio District Hospital. The works include; a new Pomio District Hospital building with 40 acute beds, 26 three bedroom staff houses and five two (2) bedroom duplexes. All constructions are in line with the National Health Services Standards and the PNG Building Code.

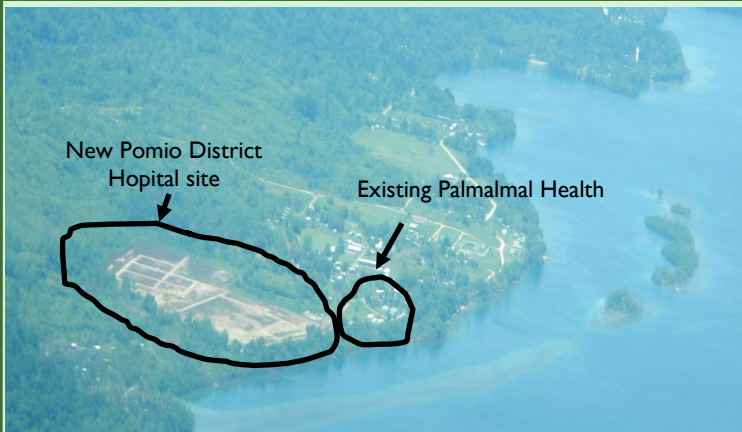
The new District Hospital will provide a full range of health services expected of a Level 4 District Hospital, and will be staffed by various cadres of health staff that will offer quality health services.

This project includes modern equipment such as x-ray, ultra sound, pathology, dental machines, sterilizer and infant warmers that will make work easier for health workers. It will ease the burdens faced by the majority of the people of Palmalmal with transport difficulties and emergencies to Rabaul that are often delayed due to bad weather conditions and transport schedules.



Above picture features the construction progress of the new Pomio District Hospital at Palmalmal, ENBP. © HSSDP | 2021

Pictures below shows construction progress of the new Pomio District Hospital at Palmalmal, Pomio District, ENBP. © HSSDP | 2021.



Above Picture: Aerial view of the new Pomio District Hospital. © HSSDP 2021

The aim for building Pomio Hospital is to ensure access to higher acuity health care and treatment for the people of Pomio District consistent with the PNG National Health Service Standards, 2011.

It will serve the most disadvantaged people in the District that live further inland of Pomio, Melkoi, Uvol and Mamusi plateaus. The people living in those areas have limited opportunities to access services including basic health services.

It will also improve maternal and child health services and address child malnutrition.

The health facility will also operate as a referral health facility accepting patients for admission and assessment from the health network across Pomio District. It has a sufficient reticulated water supply with back up water tanks and adequate supply of electricity supported with back-up generator and solar power supply.

East New Britain Provincial Health Authority will ensure effective delivery of essential healthcare services is not interrupted and that the health facility is fully staffed with qualified health staff to provide services that are needed.

A milestone and a stimulating era that will heighten health services and improve health indicators in Pomio District and East New Britain Province.

Pictures below features construction progress of the new Pomio District Hospital. District, ENBP. © HSSDP | 2021.





KOPIAGO HEALTH CENTRE - HELA PROVINCE



Above Picture: Design view of Kapiago Health Centre. © HSSDP | 2021.

Kapiago Health Centre civil works design is another facility that adapted the design of Mabudian Health Centre. Kapiago HC is currently under construction managed by HSSDP. The construction includes the main health centre with 18 acute beds, support buildings including a waiting house for expectant mothers, amenities for guardians, generator and incinerator sheds and up to 16 staff residences. All buildings will be constructed within the site of an old HC facility including the area that was set aside for future expansion.

All buildings are designed and constructed in accordance with the National Health Service Standards and the Building Code of PNG having regard to engineering, environmental, security and spatial efficiency aspects of the facilities. The design facilitates person centred care including infection prevention and control, fire control, accident prevention and disabled access through ramped entrances and adapted amenities such as bathrooms. Low-carbon and energy efficient measures, including solar power generation and solar hot water supplies will be installed.

Hela Provincial Health Authority will appoint qualified staff to fully staff the quality health facility for its people and for improving health services of their District and Province. It is a challenge that the PHA must tackle before commissioning and official opening of the Health Centre once it is completed.



Kapiago Health Centre is located in Koroba-Lake Kapiago District of Hela Province. It is one of the least developed and remote Districts in Papua New Guinea.

Aerial view of Kapiago Health Centre. The big white building on the far right is a new building. Other buildings are old and pulled down for re-development.



Aerial picture showing the old Health Centre Facility that is being pulled down and rebuilt.. Kapiago HC. ©HSSDP 2021



Above Picture: Instalment of posts for the main building. Picture below: Part of the kitchen and laundry building under construction. © HSSDP | 2021.



Bad road condition is slowing down the construction progress of Kapiago Health Centre as at times trucks get bogged down and materials are left on the road and transferred to smaller land cruiser vehicles.



Above Picture: Materials offloaded on the side road. Left picture showing materials loaded on a smaller vehicle. Both pictures also depicts bad road condition from Tari to Kapiago. © HSSDP | 2021.



BITOKARA COMMUNITY HEALTH POST— WNB



Above: Aerial view of Bitokara CHP construction. HSSDP | 2021.

The Bitokara Community Health Post subproject involves a replacement of the existing health facility at Bitokara Mission Talasea District in West New Britain Province to meet the National Health Service Standards (NHSS). The civil works design is the standard approved Community Health Post (CHP) as per the CHP Policy and will include construction of the main health facility building with 6 acute beds, support buildings including a waiting house for expectant mothers, amenities for guardians, generator and incinerator sheds and 3 staff residences. All buildings will be constructed within the grounds of the existing Catholic mission campus. The current facility is a neglected Health Centre which has not been functioning at Level 3 if assessed against the NHSS. Although the proposed replacement facility is a Level 2, the functionality and standard of care available at commissioning will be significantly improved.

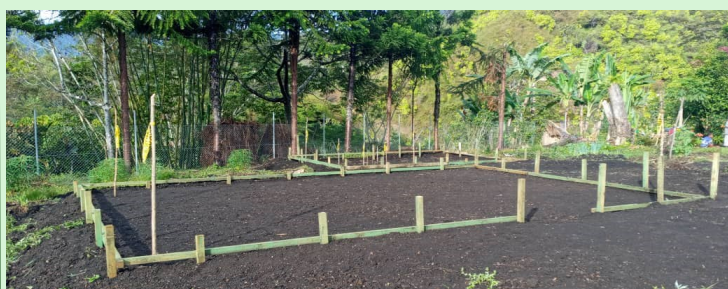
All buildings will be designed and constructed in accordance with the NHSS and the Building Code of PNG having regard to engineering, environmental, security and spatial efficiency aspects of the facilities. The design facilitates person centred care including infection prevention and control, fire control, accident prevention and disabled access through ramped entrances and adapted amenities such as bathrooms. Low-carbon and energy efficient measures, including solar power generation and solar hot water supplies will be adopted.



UMBA COMMUNITY HEALTH POST— MOROBE

Umba CHP Project was first approved under the Rural Primary Health Services Delivery Project but was not delivered due to poor road condition from Menyamya Station to Umba. The contract was ultimately novated to Mumeng in Bulolo District.

The PHA has commenced negotiations with the Provincial Administration Office and Member for Menyamya with support from the Project which resulted in both Offices and District Development Authority taking action and supported the upgrade of the Menyamya road including the road to Umba. This has allowed the contractor to proceed with the constructions of the Umba CHP.



Picture above: Construction of the Ablution block. © HSSDP | 2021.

Picture below: Installation of posts of the Main CHP building.



Picture below: Earth clearings in preparations for construction of the staff house. HSSDP | 2021.



The people of Umba will now have the privilege to access health services at their door step rather than travelling to Kainantu in Eastern Highlands Province or to Menyamya by foot looking for a better health care.

Umba had an old bush material aid post which was operated by a Community Health Worker. It will now be replaced by a brand new building and will be housed with well trained health workers which will add value to the health of the people in the area.



JIWAKA HEALTH MIDDLE MANAGEMENT TRAINING.



Jiwaka Provincial Health Authority implemented the Organisational Development Programs designed to upskill the health workers and Management staff of their health workforce. The CEO, Mr. Thaddeus Turi thanked HSSDP for this program and said that the training has clarified the roles of the PHA Board and has built their capacity in advanced management skills. Jiwaka PHA Board members sat for a day's work-shop in February where PHA Board roles and responsibilities were clarified with clear explanations from the HSSDP Human Resource Specialist.

The PHA Board appreciated the information communicated and thanked the Health Services Sector Development Project. The Board has invited the Project to continue to work with Jiwaka PHA to help maintain and build Jiwaka PHA to an effective certain level.

More than 40 senior health officers of Jiwaka Province attended a four days Health Middle Management Course at Jiwaka Resort that was facilitated by the HSSDP and was officially open and closed by the CEO of Jiwaka PHA Mr Thaddeus Turi. Mr Turi, thanked the Agencies responsible for financing HSSDP and also thanked HSSDP staff for the support given to the PHA and also for the high quality information in management which he believes will set a clear direction for Jiwaka to improve its health services.

The workshop was an eye opener for most of the Health Officers in charge of health facilities as it was the first time most of the officers attending such management training to help them run the facilities.

FEW PARTICIPANTS LEARNING INSIGHTS

- ◆ As a manager I have learnt that I will no longer direct and dictate people what to do. True art of leadership is to get people to do work enthusiastically and not by dictating and controlling them.
- ◆ I have learnt different forms of leadership, and net-working with people and organizations.
- ◆ I have identified myself in the types of leaderships that was facilitated.
- ◆ Creating a good working relationship with staff in the organization.
- ◆ I was challenged by the cultural values, and I realized that it is what has been hindering the growth and success of our Country and our Province. For PNG we still practice our cultural norms that causes barrier to most of our achievements. We must have a better understanding of how we work with our non-nationals. We need to understand cultural differences in order to build good partnerships and healthy working environments for positive growth and impacts.



GULF HEALTH MIDDLE MANAGEMENT TRAINING.

On the 14th to 19th March 2021, Gulf PHA Board Members and Staff attended the Health Middle Management Course (HMM). The first day of the course involved the Gulf PHA Board Members and the training was mainly focused on the role of the PHA Board. From the 15th to 19th March 2021, Managers and Senior Officers in the management positions attended the course including the Officers In-charge of the Health facilities in the Province. The training was held at the Catholics Conference Centre in Kerema Town.

The participants from the remote and rural areas were glad that they attended this training as most of the OICs at the health facilities are Community Health Workers (CHW) that have never been upskilled or have never learnt about management skills to manage Health Centers, Health Sub-Centers or health facilities.

Gulf PHA CEO, Dr Paul Wari thanked the Project for this training and has requested the Project to continue supporting Gulf PHA with such information and training that is required to improve basic health services to the people of Gulf Province.



During group discussions, participants have identified issues affecting health services in their Province and have pointed out that the issues are relevant to the Provincial Health Authority to deal with as part of the case studies. There were issues identified such as, lack of medical drug supplies, shortages of drugs at the health facilities, outdated drugs, no proper drug stock take records have been made, expired drugs, and drugs running out at Area Medical Store (AMS), too many drugs ordered and then not used or many drugs needed but unavailable or out of stock.

It is now up to the Gulf PHA to maneuver with approaches to address these issues.

The top five outcomes that were envisioned by the participants were;

- 1) Patient Centred Care or Patient focus.
- 2) Improved Funding.
- 3) Improved Human Resources Capacity, (skills and manpower).
- 4) Improved Infrastructure, Equipment, Supplies and Communication.
- 5) Improved Leadership, Governance, Partnership and networking.



COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT –WARA SIKAU,



Women and Children listening to the Leaders expressing their enthusiasm during talks held at Wara Sikau. © HSSDP | 2021

Health Services Sector Development Project (HSSDP) Safeguards and Health Communication Officers visited Wara Sikau on 20th to 23rd of January 2021. Wara Sikau is a proposed Community Health Post (CHP) project in Nuku District of West Sepik Province to be managed by HSSDP.

HSSDP Staff conducted the safeguards assessment, environment and health needs assessment, and also carried out a survey of the health seeking behaviour of both men and women, with different peer groups of hamlets close to Wara Sikau.



Leaders of Wara Sikau community during the consultations. © HSSDP, 2021



Above picture: Ward leader and young girls at Wara Sikau during the peer group discussions. Picture below: Men attending the consultation. © HSSDP, 2021



In the discussions held with different peer groups, it was mentioned that people in the area do not go to the nearest health facility to seek information about their health or health of their children or loved ones. The only time people go to health facilities is when they are very sick and during emergencies and for delivery of babies.

Most mothers in the interviews said that they decide to deliver at home because they fear the health workers due to their rude attitude and do not want to be sworn at where other women hears. “A woman who was among the group shared her experience of being sworn to by one of the nurses, and she has not returned after the incident.”



Men at Wara Sikau lead by their Ward Member. Wara Sikau Consultations. © HSSDP, 2021

Community members also commented that they do not trust health workers or have the trust to go to health facilities. However, people are enthusiastic about the new health facility as they have missed out on basic health services.

The woman representative of the community commented that if the CHP Project is successful and comes into their door way, it will ease all the burdens many mothers face like; dying along the road, giving birth along the way and transport difficulties which also comes in with bad road condition.

The community Leaders thanked the Project and Donors that are supporting this project and insisted that the project must reach their doorway to help their women and future generations access basic health services.



Children of Wara Sikau attending the community consultation. © HSSDP, 2021



COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT—IHU, GULF

On November 2020, the Project team comprised of Mr Kelwyn Browne, Mr Jim Dupo and Ms Dorothy Keyser Pais travelled to Ihu Station by boat from Kerema that took about 2 hours 45 minutes. Two hours was spent on the open sea and another 45 minutes from Vailala river heading to Ihu Station. Vailala River runs out to the sea and it is often hard to make it through to the mouth of the River due to weather conditions. Patients face hardships at that section because of waves. However the ride on the river is calmer than the ride at the open sea.

Ihu is in Kikori District of Gulf Province in Papua New Guinea. It is one of the remotest places in PNG. The Government of PNG has proposed to build a new Level 3 health facility at Ihu Station to replace an old health facility.



Picture above shows a part way from Vailala river towards Lopekela Village. Picture below: Raft floating on the main Vailala River. © HSSDP 2021



The purpose of the trip was to confirm State ownership of the proposed site for the new Ihu Health Centre, to conduct baseline health seeking information and receiving survey and to meet with members of the host community and selected catchment villages to identify current issues affecting health of the locals and health needs. During the interviews with the residence of the four (4) villages, of Ihu catchment, Aro, Lopekela, Ihu Station and Auma villages, the people were very much excited about the proposed project and have requested for well trained doctors and nurses to be also included at the Health Centre is currently managed by a Community Health Worker (CHW). People said that they want to have a proper responsive and quality health care, that will help to cut down on unnecessary deaths that could be managed at a level three (3) health facility such as accidents and injuries, snake bites and deliveries.



The above picture showing a run down Health facility of Ihu Health Centre that is currently being used to provide health services. Ihu, Kikori District, Gulf Province. © HSSDP 2021



Above picture shows a run down Health facility of Ihu Health Centre that is currently being used to provide health services. Ihu, Kikori District, Gulf Province. Picture below features a wooden bridge to cross to go to the health facility. © HSSDP 2021



Picture below: Men and women of Lopekela village, attending a short brief & introduction of the Project team by the Lopekela Chief. © HSSDP 2021



Women at Auma village during a peer group discussion with project staff. Ihu, Kikori District, Gulf Province. © HSSDP 2021



COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT AT KUNUA - AROB

There have been several visits to Kunua Health Centre for land confirmations and health needs assessment, environment survey and community engagement since November 2020.

Trips taken by Project staff, Mr Kelwyn Browne, Mr Jim Dupo and Miss Dorothy Keyser Pais to Kunua have been successful. However proof of the land ownership is yet to be provided to the Project for the new proposed Health Centre Project prior to tenders and construction.

The land size at the existing site is too small for the new Health Centre (HC) project. The majority of the people of Kunua are happy to have the new Health Centre Project erected at Sarimei Plantation, now known as the Kunua Plantation.

The project is being shifted to the plantation area as there are plans underway for huge development to take place since it covers more than a 100 hectares of land as explained by the District Manager for Kunua. Ten (10) hectares of land has been allocated for Health.

The project is in line with the ABG plan and the National Department of Health Plan 2011-2020.

The women of Kunua commented that this project is something which they have longed for. Many women die due to difficulties faced when delivering babies and some die along the way when they are transported to Buka Hospital. The women believe that this project may trigger changes in development and improved health indicators especially with maternal and child health.



Pictures above shows a group of children from Kunua that were around their parents during the first consultations with the people residing near Kunua Station . Below a group of in peer group discussion.
© HSSDP2021.



Left picture, wet crossing at Savon Point towards Hahon before Kunua station. Middle picture: An old bridge at Hahon. Right picture: Boat push to open sea from the river bank. © HSSDP, 2021



Picture above. An old Kunua Health Centre Facility that is currently in use to deliver health services. Kunua District, AROB, PNG.
© HSSDP, 2021

During the consultation and especially in private groups discussions the community members commented on the frustrations people face with the poor human resources at the existing health facility. Men and women made it clear that the quality of care currently delivered at the Kunua Health Centre is poor. Requests for quality care, proper examination of patients with various ailments or injuries, specialist doctors was mentioned to be part of the new proposed project. The human cost of transport to Buka and death en-route was cited in all groups. People really want the new health service, with a new clinical team with qualifications and attitude focussed on care provision.



Pictures above and below shows men and women in group discussions.
© HSSDP 2021





COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT AT TALYOKOS-ENGA

Enga PHA with its partners have come together proposing a new CHP for Talyokos in Wapenamanda District to replace an old bush material aid post facility that has been sitting there for more than 30 years without any proper facelift. The proposed Talyokos Community Health Post project will involve the construction of a new health facility at Talyokos to meet the National Health Service Standards (NHSS).

The civil works design is the approved Community Health Post (CHP) as per the CHP Policy and will include construction of the main health facility building with 6 acute beds, support buildings including a waiting house for expectant mothers, amenities for guardians, generator and incinerator sheds and up to 5 staff residences. All buildings will be constructed on a green-field site purchased by the State specifically for the health facility.

The current aid post situated adjacent to the new site is a bush material temporary facility without hygiene or sanitation facilities.



Pictures above features Talyokos current serving aid post facility both inside and outside. Picture below on the left side are CHWs. Two are currently serving the people and I has retired. © HSSDP, 2021



Picture above featuring some women during consultations. Below: Site inspection of proposed land for Proposed Talyokos CHP. ©



The trip to Talyokos was purposely for environment safeguards and confirmations of land, health needs assessment of the seeking behaviour of both men and women.

Enga PHA team led by the CEO, Mr Aaron Luai travelled with the project staff to Talyokos and did the site inspection of the piece of land allocated for the proposal of the new CHP facility project. The team met with the customary land owners and the members of the community for land confirmation, safeguards, and health needs assessment.

A community consultation was conducted with different peer groups. Most stories related back to the past where life was tougher with no good road, no proper bridge to cross over to go to get health care at other nearby health facilities and long distance of climbing the mountainous terrain to access basic health services at Tsak Health facility or due to drug shortages or no health staff.

There is now an upgrade of the road, a bridge has been constructed which allows women to travel to Wapenamanda to seek medical care. Power is now installed which will be beneficial for the new CHP project.

Picture below: PMG Power installing power to Talyokos village. © HSSDP, 2021





GAULIM COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT –ENBP

A study on the health seeking behaviours of women and men towards primary health care was successfully completed in Gaulim catchment communities by the Social Safeguards Team of HSSDP, which was conducted on the 29th to 31st of March 2021.

Social safeguards assessments, environment surveys, clinical and National Health Service Standards baselines and community engagement were completed with support from the East New Britain Provincial Health Authority and Gazelle District Health Officers.

There are similar stories from previous community engagements and assessments conducted where local people are longing for better health service delivery to their local communities.

There were common issues raised by the community members during the consultations, relating to difficulties of transporting patients to referral health facility and travel distances for some villages that are far away which leads to deaths along the road.

Discussions held with the younger group of boys was heart breaking as most parents or elderly people do not realise that the younger boys and girls are already watching explicit movies online and are wrongly influenced by the internet. There is no control over the use of mobile phones and it is not healthy for our young generation's future. Apart from such finding, all members of the communities that were visited, want a quality health service for their people.



A Community Leader at Gaulim during the consultation.© HSSDP, 2021



Picture above features a run down building at Gaulim Health Centre, ENBP. © HSSDP, 2021



Above pictures: Current setting of Gaulim Health Centre. © HSSDP, 2021



Gaulim women posing for a shot at Gaulim Health Centre.

The people are striving for a better health facility that could address the most pressing issue of transport, and those who travel far distances to seek proper basic health services.

During the consultations, most of the women said that this project will also help to address difficulties faced by women especially with deliveries and child health. However, most commented that there is a huge need to improve manpower at the health facility and more focus to be given to clients as some people walk distances just to seek health services that are denied to them due to most aid post not having enough drug supplies or health worker may be sick and not at work or the health worker is not working.

It was revealed during the assessment that people living in far distances walk for a day or two depending on the distance when they are very sick or when an urgency arises for a patient to be treated. At times these people are accommodated by villagers along the road while travelling to the health centre to seek medical care. These people need to be accommodated for some time to recover before they are sent back to their villages.